

Beatriz Maldonado

Palo Alto, CA

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (UIUC)

August 2015 - May 2022

Ph.D., Department of Anthropology

Scripps College, Claremont Colleges

August 2011 - May 2015

B.A., American Studies and Hispanic Studies

Cum Laude Honors & Dual Major Honors Thesis

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign (UIUC)

August 2015 - May 2022

Graduate Research Assistant; Teacher Assistant

- Assisted Anthropology professors with data analysis of interviews and grant proposals, contributed to grading essays, assessing study groups and creating test surveys, exams and score sheets

Illinois Graduate College: Diversity, Equity & Inclusion

Summer 2021

Summer Research Opportunities Program (SROP) Coordinator

- Coordinated SROP 2021 curriculum online for 45 underrepresented undergraduate students (students of color from low-income, first-generation, and migrant communities) and graduate student staff. Responsibilities included facilitation of weekly staff meetings, professional development seminars, virtual conference trainings and orientation, partnership with faculty at the University of Illinois. SROP programming focused on providing accessible and equitable resources and information about the culture of graduate school research experiences (themes consisted of ethics in research, CV/Resume building, personal statements for graduate programs, funding graduate program, and effective conference presentations).

UIUC Grad College Dissertation Travel Grant

July 2019 - August 2020

Ethnographic Researcher

- Dissertation titled "Ordinary Salvanness and the Exceptional Everyday: An ethnography of ordinariness in spatial and temporal states of exception within the lives of diasporic Salvadorans in Los Angeles." This dissertation research focuses on experiences of migrant life, narratives of violence, and everyday practices of survival and belonging. In particular, this research focuses on diasporic Salvadoran communities residing in Los Angeles, California. This project engages in the understudied concept of the mundane and banal of daily life for its potential to serve as a form of resistance, pedagogy, and survival in postwar life.

Illinois Graduate College: Diversity, Equity & Inclusion

Summer 2019

Summer Research Opportunities Program (SROP) Research Team Leader

- Led the 2019 Social Sciences Research Group of undergraduate students; provided feedback for a research project (formulating a research question, proposals, final research papers, and conference presentations).
- Guided students step-by-step on the culture of graduate school, mentorship with faculty members of the University of Illinois, and navigating the campus and its resources of academic and social support/guidance.

Girls Who Code (GWC) Summer Immersion Program

Summer 2017 & Summer 2018

Site Lead

- Supervisor for six Los Angeles programs; each program consisted of a Teaching Team of a Teacher and two Teaching Assistants, 20 high school young women, and Partner Contacts (including The Walt Disney Company; Warner Bros.; AT&T; Salesforce; University of Southern California (USC); and Blizzard Entertainment).
- Coordinated remote and physical communication with Teaching Team members, students, families, and Partner Contacts; traveled to different sites in the greater Los Angeles area; managed staff and student meetings, emergencies (family incidents and transportation concerns), food distribution, fieldtrip events; budgeted resources and supplies of technology for students and families; completed general and individual check-ins with students, staff, and GWC Headquarters Staff.
- Provided mentorship opportunities for college applications, graduate school, and professional development during and after the Summer Immersion Program.

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

Dr. Jonathan Inda, Latina/Latino Studies, UIUC

July 2016 - May 2019

- Deathscares: Violence and Race in Settler Societies. Focusing on quantitative and qualitative research on border deaths in the United States: violence between Custom Border Patrol agents and victim deaths.

Dr. Maritza Quiñones, Department of Anthropology, UIUC

August 2016 - May 2019

- Managed social media profiles of the Anthropology department for events including lectures and job talks, writing seminars, and community outreach programs. Supported undergraduate students with Anthropology majors as they devised their summer research projects with Anthropology faculty.

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

National and International Conferences

- Maldonado, Beatriz. (2019, November). *Remembrance and memorialization: Exploring Salvadoran families' contributions to monuments of the disappeared*. Paper Presentation at the American Anthropological Association (AAA) conference.
- Maldonado, Beatriz. (2019, November). *Creating Borderland worldings through remembrance and reconciliation: Diasporic Salvadorans in Los Angeles*. Paper Presentation at the American Studies Association (ASA) conference.
- Maldonado, Beatriz. (2019, April). *Creating Borderland worldings through digital remembrance and resilience*. Paper Presentation at NYU New YorkScapes Culture Mapping Conference: Migrations.
- Maldonado, Beatriz. (2018, November). *Exploring Salvadoran families' contributions of memory and kinship for the monuments of the Disappeared*. Paper Presentation at the Liberated Futures: Colloquium on Central America and the Caribbean at California State University Los Angeles.
- Maldonado, Beatriz. (2018, July). *To remember and memorialize: exploring Salvadoran families' contributions to the monuments of the Disappeared*. Paper Presentation at Liverpool Hope University, Identity and Memory in War and Peacebuilding Annual International Conference.

ACHIEVEMENTS

Awards

- The American Association of Hispanics in Higher Education (AAHHE) and Educational Testing Service and (ETS) Outstanding Dissertations Competition semi-finalist (2022); National Science Foundation (NSF) Honorable Mention (2016); Cum Laude distinction at Scripps College (2015); Hispanic Studies Senior Thesis Award (2015); Employee of the Year: Scripps College Academy, Scripps College (2015).

Publications

- Maldonado, Beatriz. (Forthcoming, 2022). "Claiming and Making Space through Student Activism: USC's Central American Network." Peer-reviewed chapter section in anthology, *Engendering Central American Mujeres Testimonios*, edited by Karen Alma, Ester Hernandez, Alicia Estrada, and Yajaira Padilla.
- Terrones, Lettycia and Maldonado, Beatriz. (2019). "Death by Policing: Race, State Violence, and the Possibility of Justice." Peer-reviewed article. *Illinois 150: The 21st Century Research University and the Public Good*, edited by Kevin Hamilton, Windsor Downs Press, 2019. <https://doi.org/10.21900/wd.8>

MENTORSHIP & LEADERSHIP

University of Southern California's (USC)

September 2020 - May 2022

- Serving as a mentor to USC's Leslie and William McMorrow Neighborhood Academic Initiative, I worked with 11th and 12th grade students in guiding them through professional development and college readiness.

Heart of Los Angeles (HOLA) Non-Profit Organization

September 2019 - March 2020

- As Academic and Enrichment Coordinator, I facilitated 11th and 12th grade programming structure and enrichment courses; communicated with external community partner organizations and programs; coordinated academic intervention workshops and bootcamps; mentored students in college applications; supported students with academic support and learning sessions focused on college readiness and study habits.

SKILLS

- Research methodologies** include ethnography, field studies, qualitative and quantitative methods, participant observation, data analysis, surveys, interviews, diary studies, international research
- Language fluency** in Spanish and English reading, speaking and writing; translation practices
- Interpersonal skills** as goal-oriented, organized, responsible, transparent communication